

Daniel Okafor

Senior Backend / Platform Engineer

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SUMMARY

7 years of backend and platform engineering. Strong Python, AWS and Kubernetes. Started integrating LLM features into product surfaces in 2024.

SKILLS

Languages: Python, Go, SQL

Backend: FastAPI, Django REST, gRPC, PostgreSQL, Kafka

Cloud / Ops: AWS (EKS, ECS, Lambda, RDS), Kubernetes, Terraform, Docker, ArgoCD

AI / LLM: OpenAI API, RAG (pgvector), prompt templating

CI/CD: GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Datadog

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Platform Engineer - Kite Commerce (Feb 2021 - Present)

- Own a 60-service Kubernetes platform on EKS; drove p99 latency down 38% through connection pooling and autoscaling policy work.
- Built an internal RAG-backed documentation assistant using pgvector and the OpenAI API, served from FastAPI; ~900 weekly internal users.
- Standardised CI/CD across 60 repos with GitHub Actions and ArgoCD.
- Implemented function calling for a support-ticket classifier that routes to internal APIs.

Backend Engineer - Paystream (Sep 2018 - Jan 2021)

- Built Django REST and FastAPI services for a payments gateway.
- Migrated batch jobs to Kafka streaming; cut settlement lag from 30m to 90s.

EDUCATION

B.Sc., Computer Science - University of Lagos, 2018

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (2022)

AWS Certified DevOps Engineer - Professional (2023)